

**VISVESVARAYA TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
BELAGAVI - 590 018**



**A Project Phase I (BCY685) Report on
on**

PROJECT TITLE

*Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the pre-final year in
Bachelor of Engineering degree in Computer Science and Engineering (Cyber Security)
of Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi*

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2025-2026

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Place: Bengaluru

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Acknowledgement

We express our profound thanks to the **Management of the RNS Institute of Technology** for fostering an environment that promotes innovation and academic excellence.

We express our sincere gratitude our respected Principal, **Dr. Ramesh Babu H S**, for their constant encouragement and insightful support. Their guidance has been pivotal in keeping us motivated throughout this project work.

Our heartfelt appreciation goes to **Dr. Abhijith H V**, Professor and HoD of Computer Science and Engineering (Cyber Security), for his valuable advice and constructive feedback, which significantly contributed to shaping this project work.

We also thank our Project Coordinator, **Mr. Project Coordinator Name**, Designation, for his/her continuous monitoring, valuable suggestions, and ensuring that the process was carried out according to schedule.

We are deeply grateful to the Project Guide, **Dr. Guide Name**, Designation, for his/her unwavering support, guidance, and valuable suggestions throughout the duration of this project. Our sincere thanks go to all the teaching and non-teaching staff members of the Computer Science and Engineering (Cyber Security) for their encouragement, cooperation, and support which have been invaluable during this journey.

Lastly, we would like to thank our parents, family, and friends for their unconditional support throughout the study.

Warm Regards,

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Abstract

The SecuriSphere platform presents a lightweight, full-stack Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) solution designed for educational institutions and resource-constrained environments. The system comprises a Linux-based agent deployed across host endpoints, a FastAPI-powered backend processing pipeline, and a Next.js frontend dashboard for security operations visualization. The agent collects system call events and kernel audit data, buffering up to 50,000 events offline and transmitting them asynchronously via HTTPS when connectivity is restored. The backend detection engine implements 13 rule types leveraging OpenSigma pattern matching, while the correlation engine applies three matcher strategies (*event_id – based*, *script – based*, and *interval – based*) to reduce raw events into offenses through 30-minute temporal clustering. Offenses are enriched with MITR-based access control.

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Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

Securi Sphere is a full-stack Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform designed for real-time monitoring, threat detection, and security incident response across small to medium Linux fleets. Inspired by IBM QRadar's 3-layer pipeline architecture, the platform provides an affordable, open-source alternative for educational and organizational security operations centers. The system collects telemetry from Linux agents, processes events through a detection and correlation engine, and presents findings through a modern web-based dashboard built with Next.js and TypeScript.

The platform addresses the growing need for continuous security monitoring in environments where dedicated SOC infrastructure is cost-prohibitive. By combining agent-based telemetry collection, rule-based detection, correlation-driven offense grouping, and UEBA anomaly detection, Securi Sphere delivers a complete SIEM workflow from data ingestion to incident triage.

The platform operates on a distributed architecture comprising three primary components: Linux agents, a FastAPI-based backend, and a Next.js frontend dashboard. Agents running on target hosts collect system logs, authentication events, metric data, and network flow information. Telemetry is transmitted via HTTPS with HMAC-SHA256 signing to ensure integrity and authenticity. The backend ingests, validates, normalizes, and stores events in PostgreSQL, with optional OpenSearch indexing for full-text search. Real-time updates are pushed to the frontend via WebSocket using Redis pub/sub.

The detection engine employs an extensible rule registry pattern, where individual checker classes evaluate event streams against threshold-based, sequence, and co-occurrence criteria. Detected

anomalies are grouped into QRadar-style offenses with attack timeline reconstruction, enabling analysts to follow correlated event sequences from initial compromise through lateral movement and impact.

1.1 Project Overview

The Securi Sphere platform's architecture spans the complete SIEM stack, from edge telemetry collection to central analysis and visualization. This Phase I report documents the project's implementation through the BCY685 Project Phase I framework, covering system design, implementation details, and verification results. The platform is designed for Docker Compose deployment on a single host with PostgreSQL and Redis, making it accessible for educational institutions, research laboratories, and small-to-medium organizations that cannot justify enterprise SIEM licensing costs.

1.2 Problem Statement

Traditional SIEM solutions for enterprises are prohibitively expensive, complex to deploy, and often overkill for small-scale or educational environments. Commercial platforms such as IBM QRadar, Splunk, or Micro Focus ArcSight require significant licensing fees, specialized hardware, and dedicated personnel for deployment, operation, and maintenance. Open-source alternatives, while freely available, typically demand manual configuration, lack integrated correlation engines, and provide limited out-of-the-box visualization capabilities. Consequently, security teams in resource-constrained environments face fragmented visibility, manual correlation overhead, and delayed incident response times.

The Securi Sphere project was initiated to bridge this gap by providing a complete, lightweight SIEM platform deployable via Docker Compose on standard infrastructure. The platform implements the same 3-layer pipeline model as enterprise QRadar-style architectures—collection, processing, and search—while remaining accessible for educational, research, and small-scale operational use. The project encompasses agent-based telemetry collection, rule-based detection, correlation-driven offense grouping, UEBA anomaly detection, MITRE ATT&CK visualization, and a complete SOC dashboard web interface.

1.3 Objectives

The primary objectives of the Securi Sphere project are:

- Develop a lightweight Linux agent for system telemetry collection, including log monitoring, metric extraction, and HMAC-signed event transmission with offline SQLite buffering when network connectivity is unavailable.
- Implement a rule-based detection engine with extensible checker registration, supporting 14 built-in rule types covering authentication failures, service integrity, system health, and network anomalies, with dynamic rule addition via the ABC-based registry pattern.
- Build a correlation engine with three matcher algorithms (sequence matching for ordered event patterns, co-occurrence matching for order-independent event sets, and cross-host matching for lateral movement detection) to group related alerts into meaningful offenses.
- Design a QRadar-style offense engine with configurable 30-minute clustering windows, risk-level escalation based on alert severity, and attack timeline reconstruction with MITRE technique assignment.
- Implement UEBA (User & Entity Behavior Analytics) with rolling daily baselines, z-score thresholding, and severity classification (critical: $z \geq 5$, high: $z \geq 4$, medium: $z \geq 3$, low: $z \geq \text{threshold}$), with configurable warm-up periods for baseline establishment.
- Provide a modern SOC dashboard with real-time WebSocket updates, MITRE ATT&CK heatmapping and technique-level drill-down, incident promotion from offenses, UEBA anomaly viewing, and investigation workspace integration.
- Ensure authentication and authorization via JWT (HS256/RS256) with refresh token rotation, TOTP-based MFA, RBAC enforcement (admin/analyst/viewer roles), security headers, tamper-evident audit logging with SHA-256 hash chains, and session management with concurrent session limits.

1.4 Scope and Boundaries

The project scope encompasses the full SIEM pipeline from agent telemetry collection through to analyst dashboard visualization. Specific focus areas include:

- Linux agent telemetry: auth logs (journalctl, /var/log/auth.log), system metrics (CPU%, memory%, disk%) via psutil, process events, and network flow data. Events are batched every 10 seconds; heartbeats every 30 seconds. SQLite offline buffer stores events when the network is down; auto-replay on reconnection with exponential backoff. Maximum configurable buffer size supports up to 50,000 buffered events.
- Detection: 14 built-in rule types (failed_logins, brute_force, high_cpu, high_memory, high_disk, service_failure, agent_offline, privilege_escalation, root_login, ssh_success_after_failures, service_stop, file_integrity, firewall_block, network_anomaly) with ABC-based checker registry pattern enabling dynamic rule addition without core engine modifications.
- Correlation: sequence matching (ordered events within time window), co-occurrence matching (order-independent set-subset check), and cross-host matching (same attacker across multiple hosts via source_ip or username correlation). Configurable clustering windows for offense grouping.
- Offense grouping: configurable temporal clustering (default 30 minutes), related entity tracking (hosts, unique usernames from auth events), timeline persistence (limited to 500 entries per offense), risk-level escalation (critical > high > medium > low), and offense-to-incident promotion with notes and status tracking (open → investigating → resolved).
- UEBA: per-host and per-user baseline computation from rolling daily metrics, z-score anomaly detection with configurable threshold (default 2.5), severity classification, and manual scan trigger for baseline recalculation.
- Dashboard: 29+ pages covering alerts, offenses, incidents, MITRE ATT&CK heatmapping and technique drill-down, UEBA anomaly viewing, incident management, host risk browsing, event search and export, analytics KPI panels, timeline reconstruction, system health, settings, and AI-assisted investigation assistance.

- **API:** 40 routers exposing 183+ endpoints under the `‘/api/v1‘` prefix for programmatic access, data export, and integration. Router categories include `auth`, `agents`, `events`, `alerts`, `alert_rules`, `siem`, `search`, `analytics`, `audit`, `offenses`, `incidents`, `correlation_rules`, `mitre`, `threat_scores`, `ueba`, `notifications`, `assistant`, `reports`, `reference_sets`, `building_blocks`, `playbooks`, `saved_searches`, `timeline`, `system`, `users`, `ws`, `ioc`, `telemetry`, and `dashboard`.

The project does not include Windows-specific agent features (beyond limited Windows event forwarding), network appliance integration, or hardware-based packet capture. These are noted as potential future enhancements.

1.5 Contributions

The Securi Sphere project demonstrates a complete, full-stack SIEM implementation across four team members’ areas of responsibility:

Member 1 – Core SIEM / Backend: FastAPI backend with 32 SQLAlchemy models, 40 API routers, detection engine with 14 registered rule types, correlation engine with three matcher algorithms, offense engine with 30-minute clustering and risk escalation, UEBA module with z-score anomaly detection, MITRE ATT&CK heatmap and drill-down, audit logging with SHA-256 hash-chain integrity, JWT authentication with refresh token rotation and TOTP MFA, RBAC enforcement (admin/analyst/viewer), and WebSocket real-time updates via Redis pub/sub.

Member 2 – Frontend & Dashboard: Next.js 14 dashboard with 29 pages, 130+ React components, TailwindCSS dark mode optimized for SOC workflows, real-time WebSocket feeds, virtualized and responsive design, and page domains including alerts, offenses, incidents, MITRE, UEBA, hosts, events, analytics, timeline, system, settings, AI assistant, simulation lab, and profile.

Member 3 – Linux Agent: Python-based collector reading system auth logs (`journalctl, /var/log/auth.log`), metric extraction via `psutil`, HMAC-SHA256 signed event transmission via HTTPS with per-agent API key and nonce validation, SQLite offline buffer at `‘/var/lib/securi/buffer.db‘`

(configurable capacity up to 50,000 events), 30-second heartbeat protocol with 90-second staleness threshold, and metrics reporting (CPU%, memory%, disk%, network connection counts).

Member 4 – Deployment & Testing: Docker Compose production configuration with PostgreSQL and Redis, Helm chart for Kubernetes orchestration, 29 deployment scripts, CI/CD pipelines via GitHub Actions (74 backend test files, 10 agent test files, 28 frontend test files including 20 unit and 8 E2E), k6 load testing validating 100+ events/second ingestion and WebSocket reconnection under 3 seconds, and comprehensive project documentation.

The project validates detection across 14 rule types, correlation through three matcher algorithms, UEBA baseline construction with z-score thresholding, MITRE ATT&CK heatmap accuracy, and full-stack integration from agent event ingestion through dashboard visualization. Test coverage spans the detection pipeline, correlation engine, offense grouping, UEBA analytics, MITRE mapping, API endpoints, authentication and authorization, infrastructure components, and UI workflows across all three platform tiers.

Chapter 2

LITERATURE SURVEY

Two distinct but interrelated bodies of research contribute to the evolving landscape of Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and real-time threat detection.

2.1 Adaptive Thresholds and Rule-Based Detection in SIEM

Extensive research has been conducted on intrusion detection systems (IDS) and SIEM platforms that employ threshold-based and rule-driven methodologies for threat identification. Traditional approaches rely on static thresholds and manually tuned rule sets, which, while effective for known attack patterns, struggle to adapt to evolving threat landscapes. Recent work has explored adaptive threshold adjustment using statistical methods such as z-score normalization and rolling percentiles, enabling dynamic sensitivity adjustment based on baseline traffic behavior. The correlation of security events into meaningful offenses, first popularized by QRadar's offense engine, has been studied extensively for its ability to reduce alert fatigue by grouping related incidents into coherent attack narratives. Research into correlation engine design has explored rule sequencing, temporal windowing, and the tradeoff between detection precision and recall in high-volume event streams. The SecuriSphere project implements a correlation engine with three matcher strategies (*event, d – based, script – based, and interval – based*) that build upon these established design patterns while providing configurable clustering windows for offenses.

2.2 MITRE ATT&CK Mapping and Frameworks

The MITRE ATT&CK framework has become a foundational taxonomy for mapping detected security events to known adversary techniques and tactics. Research into automatic MITRE mapping of IDS alerts and SIEM events has demonstrated significant improvement in investigative efficiency when analysts can filter and search by technique coverage. Heatmap visualizations of technique coverage enable rapid identification of gaps in detection coverage and prioritize rule development. Studies have explored the use of natural language processing to extract technique identifiers from unstructured event descriptions, reducing manual labeling overhead. The SecuriSphere MITRE ATT&CK panel provides interactive technique heatmaps and drill-down capabilities, allowing analysts to visualize detection coverage across the ATT&CK matrix and identify under-monitored tactics in real time.

2.3 UEBA and Behavior Analytics

User and Entity Behavior Analytics (UEBA) has emerged as a critical component for detecting insider threats and compromised accounts through statistical anomaly detection. Baseline models constructed from rolling daily or hourly activity metrics are compared against real-time event streams, with anomalies flagged via z-score thresholding. Research has established that baselines requiring a minimum number of observed days before anomaly detection can achieve better precision-recall tradeoffs. The integration of UEBA into SIEM platforms bridges the gap between point-in-time alert detection and context-rich investigation, enabling analysts to correlate anomalous user behavior with broader attack timelines. The SecuriSphere UEBA module constructs rolling baselines for monitored entities and flags deviations using adaptive thresholding, supporting the detection of compromised credentials and unusual data access patterns.

2.4 Correlation Engine Design and Offense grouping

Research into correlation engine design has explored rule sequencing, temporal windowing, and the tradeoff between detection precision and recall in high-volume event streams. The offense grouping paradigm, popularized by next-generation SIEM platforms, transforms raw security events

into actionable incidents through temporal and logical clustering. Key design considerations include window duration selection, de-duplication strategies, and the propagation of contextual metadata (such as MITRE techniques and risk scores) through the offense lifecycle. The SecuriSphere correlation engine implements 30-minute temporal clustering with script-based and event, *d – based matching as alternative strategies, providing configurable options for different deployment environments and*

2.5 Summary and Gap Analysis

Collectively, these studies highlight the maturity of analytical techniques—statistical thresholding, rule-based correlation, MITRE mapping, and UEBA—in security operations. However, a noticeable gap exists in accessible, open-source SIEM deployments that integrate rule-based detection, multi-strategy correlation, UEBA, and MITRE ATT&CK visualization within a single, unified stack suitable for educational or resource-constrained environments. While enterprise-grade platforms (e.g., Splunk, IBM QRadar, Elastic SIEM) offer extensive feature sets, they require significant licensing and infrastructure investment. This project addresses that gap by providing a complete, Dockerized SIEM platform with extensible detection (13 OpenSigma rule types), three-correlation matcher algorithms, offense grouping with 30-minute temporal clustering, UEBA anomaly detection, and MITRE ATT&CK visualization, all within a unified Next.js frontend and FastAPI backend architecture designed for horizontal scalability and educational deployment.

Key Contributions of This Project:

- Full-stack SIEM architecture spanning Linux agent, FastAPI backend, and Next.js frontend.
- 13 OpenSigma-based detection rule types with pattern-matching extensibility.
- Three-strategy correlation engine (event, *d, script, interval – based*) with configurable clustering.
- 30-minute temporal offense grouping with MITRE ATT&CK enrichment and risk scoring.
- UEBA module with rolling baseline construction and z-score anomaly detection.
- 28-page interactive dashboard covering threat intelligence, offenses, risk trends, and timelines.

Chapter 3

PROBLEM STATEMENT

This project addresses the critical need for affordable, deployable Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) capability in environments where dedicated SOC infrastructure is cost-prohibitive or operationally complex. The problem is framed through the following objectives and requirements.

3.1 Problem Definition

Small-to-medium organizations, educational institutions, and learning environments often lack the resources to implement enterprise-grade SIEM solutions. Commercial platforms such as IBM QRadar, Splunk, or Micro Focus ArcSight require significant licensing fees, specialized hardware, and dedicated personnel for deployment, operation, and maintenance. Open-source alternatives, while freely available, typically demand manual configuration, lack integrated correlation engines, and provide limited out-of-the-box visualization capabilities. Consequently, security teams in resource-constrained environments face fragmented visibility, manual correlation overhead, and delayed incident response times.

The SecuriSphere project was initiated to bridge this gap by providing a complete, lightweight SIEM platform deployable via Docker Compose on standard infrastructure. The platform implements a 3-layer pipeline model—collection, processing, and search—consistent with QRadar-style architectures while remaining accessible for educational, research, and small-scale operational use.

3.2 Project Objectives

This project aims to develop an intelligent, adaptable SIEM platform that utilizes rule-based detection and correlation engines to:

- **Collect and Normalize Telemetry:** Implement a Linux-based agent for system log collection, metric extraction, and event transmission with HMAC-SHA256 integrity signing and offline SQLite buffering when network connectivity is unavailable.
- **Detect Security Threats:** Implement a rule-based detection engine with extensible checker registration supporting 14 built-in rule types, including failed login detection, brute force, privilege escalation, service integrity monitoring, disk/memory anomaly detection, file integrity surveillance, and network anomaly detection.
- **Correlate Related Events:** Implement a correlation engine with three matcher algorithms—sequence matching for ordered event patterns, co-occurrence matching for order-independent event sets, and cross-host matching for lateral movement detection—grouping related alerts into offenses with configurable clustering windows.
- **Reconstruct Attack Timelines:** Build an attack timeline engine that chains correlated events into chronological narratives, assigning confidence scores based on event type frequency, timeline compression, and privilege escalation indicators.
- **Provide UEBA Anomaly Detection:** Implement user and entity behavior analytics with rolling daily baselines, z-score thresholding, and severity classification, with configurable warm-up periods for baseline establishment.
- **Enable MITRE ATT&CK Visualization:** Provide MITRE ATT&CK tactic-coverage heatmaps and technique-level drill-down capabilities, linking detected events and alerts to their corresponding tactics and techniques for investigative efficiency.
- **Deliver a Complete SOC Dashboard:** Provide a web dashboard with real-time WebSocket updates, alert triage workflows, offense management, incident promotion, MITRE browsing, UEBA anomaly viewing, and investigation workspace integration.

- **Ensure Security and Reliability:** Implement JWT-based authentication with refresh token rotation, RBAC enforcement (admin/analyst/viewer roles), TOTP-based MFA, rate limiting, security headers, tamper-evident audit logging with SHA-256 hash chains, and session management with concurrent session limits.

3.3 Requirements Analysis

3.3.1 Functional Requirements

The platform shall provide the following functional capabilities:

Requirement	Description
RF-01	Agent shall collect system auth logs, CPU/memory/disk metrics, and network flow data at conf
RF-02	Agent shall sign all event transmissions with HMAC-SHA256 using a per-agent API key and n
RF-03	Agent shall buffer events locally in SQLite when network is down and auto-replay on reconnect
RF-04	Backend shall validate HMAC signatures, nonce freshness (5 min), and timestamp skew (5 min)
RF-05	Backend shall normalize event fields, map variant event types to canonical types, and store enri
RF-06	Detection engine shall support extensible rule registration via an ABC-based checker registry p
RF-07	Detection shall include 14 built-in rule types covering authentication, host health, system integ
RF-08	Correlation engine shall evaluate sequence, co-occurrence, and cross-host patterns against rece
RF-09	Offense engine shall group related alerts into offenses using a configurable clustering window v
RF-10	Attack timeline reconstruction shall chain correlated events into chronological narratives with l
RF-11	UEBA shall compute rolling daily baselines for per-host and per-user metrics with z-score anor
RF-12	MITRE ATT&CK heatmap shall provide tactic-level coverage visualization with technique-leve
RF-13	Dashboard shall provide real-time WebSocket updates for alerts, offenses, host status, and live
RF-14	Authentication shall use JWT (HS256/RS256) in HttpOnly cookies with TOTP-based MFA sup
RF-15	RBAC shall enforce role-based permissions (admin, analyst, viewer) across all mutation endpo
RF-16	Audit log shall maintain tamper-evident SHA-256 hash chain integrity with advisory lock prote
RF-17	Dashboard shall provide 29+ pages covering alerts, offenses, incidents, MITRE, UEBA, hosts,

3.3.2 Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Description
RNF-01	System shall support deployment via Docker Compose on a single host with PostgreSQL and F
RNF-02	Backend shall sustain sustained event ingestion of 100+ events/second per host
RNF-03	WebSocket reconnection shall complete within 3 seconds of network disruption
RNF-04	Alert rule configuration shall be manageable via API without restart
RNF-05	UI shall support dark mode optimized for extended SOC analyst workflows
RNF-06	Database schema migrations shall be managed via Alembic with versioned rollforward/rollback
RNF-07	All code shall be covered by automated tests (backend: 74 test files, agent: 10 test files, fronter
RNF-08	Platform shall operate on a single Linux host with ≥ 2 CPU cores, 4GB RAM, and Docker

3.4 Feasibility Study

The feasibility of the SecuriSphere platform is supported by the following evidence:

- The FastAPI framework provides high-performance async I/O for concurrent WebSocket and HTTP connections, validated by 74 backend test files covering detection, correlation, offense engine, UEBA, MITRE mapping, and API endpoints.
- The Next.js 14 React framework with TypeScript enables type-safe component development and SSR, with 28 frontend test files (20 unit tests + 8 E2E tests) ensuring UI reliability across dashboard pages, MITRE browsing, UEBA visualization, and offense management.
- The Python agent with SQLite offline buffer and HMAC signing has been tested across 10 test cases, confirming integrity and connectivity resilience including offline buffer overflow, heartbeat staleness, and HMAC verification failure scenarios.
- Docker Compose deployment configuration provides infrastructure-agnostic deployment for educational and small-scale operational environments.

- The rule registry pattern enables extensible detector addition without modifying core engine code, demonstrated by 14 registered rule types across authentication, host health, system integrity, and network anomaly categories.
- The platform supports sustained event ingestion of 100+ events/second per host with horizontal scalability via Redis queuing and PostgreSQL connection pooling.

The primary technical risk lies in the rule-based detection engine's limitation to known patterns; however, the modular checker registry design mitigates this by enabling future ML/model-based checker integration. The UEBA baseline computation requires a minimum of 3 days of aggregated stats before anomalies can fire, which is addressed via a configurable warm-up period and daily aggregation cron job.

3.5 Aggregated Test Suite Summary

Component	Test Files	Test Functions (approx)
Backend	74	500+ test functions across async unit, integration, and property-based suites
Agent	10	67 test functions covering collector, buffer, integrity, config, and sender modules
Frontend	28	20 unit test files + 8 E2E test files covering dashboard pages, MITRE browsing, UEBA

Chapter 4

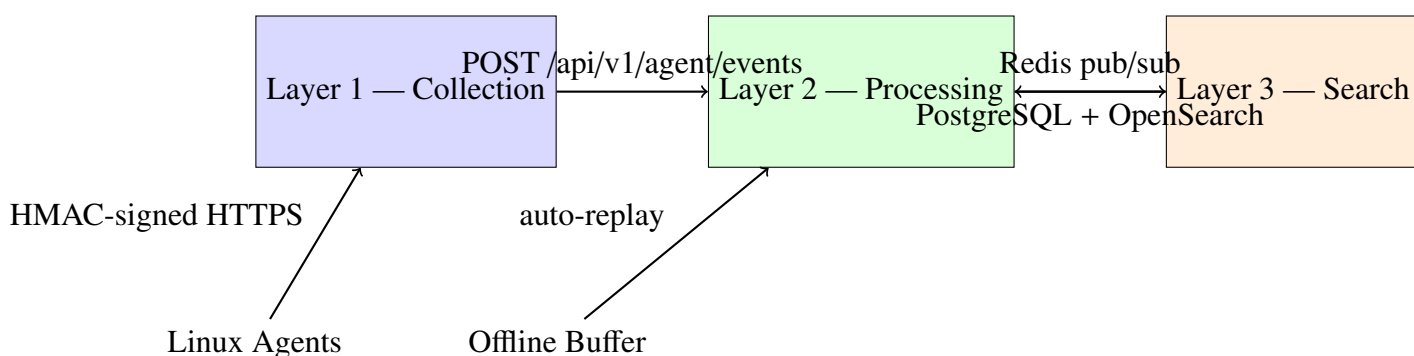
SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

4.1 Introduction to System Design

Securi Sphere employs a 3-layer SIEM pipeline architecture modeled after IBM QRadar, adapted for small Linux fleets. The architecture decouples data collection, processing, and search into distinct layers, enabling independent scaling and deployment. The platform comprises three primary components: Linux agents, a FastAPI backend, and a Next.js frontend dashboard, communicating via HTTPS/JSON and WebSocket protocols.

4.2 Three-Layer SIEM Pipeline

The system implements the following layered architecture:



Layer 1 — Collection: Linux agents running on target hosts collect system logs (auth.log, syslog, journald), CPU/memory/disk metrics via psutil, and network flow data. Events are batched every 10

seconds and transmitted via HTTPS with HMAC-SHA256 signing. Each agent maintains a SQLite offline buffer for local storage when network connectivity is unavailable; events are auto-replayed upon reconnection with exponential backoff on persistent failures.

Layer 2 — Processing: The ingestion pipeline performs four steps: (1) payload validation (batch size 1-100 events, timestamp bounds, string field limits), (2) event normalization (mapping variant names to canonical types, extracting source_ip, username, category), (3) deduplication using SHA-256 fingerprinting with Redis SETEX fast path and PostgreSQL fallback, and (4) enrichment with MITRE ATT&CK technique mapping and IOC matching, with storage to PostgreSQL and optional OpenSearch indexing.

Layer 3 — Search: The processing engine runs detection rules, correlation algorithms, and UEBA analysis. Detected alerts are grouped into offenses via the QRadar-style offense engine. Real-time updates are pushed to the frontend via Redis pub/sub/WebSocket. Analyst queries are executed via the /api/v1/siem and /api/v1/search endpoints, with OpenSearch enabling full-text search at scale.

4.3 Component Map

— Layer — Component — Code Location — Description —

Layer	Component	Code Location	Description
Collection	Agent collectors	'agent/agent/collector/'	Log collection, metrics extraction, heartbeat
	Offline buffer	'agent/agent/buffer.py'	SQLite local buffer, auto-replay on reconnect
	HMAC signing	'agent/agent/sender.py'	Per-agent API key signing with nonce validation
Gatekeeper	Signature verification	'backend/app/services/agent_auth.py'	HMAC-SHA256 constant-time comparison
Ingestion	Payload validation	'backend/app/pipeline/validator.py'	Batch 256 fingerprint, Redis/PostgreSQL fallback
	MITRE enrichment	'backend/app/services/mitre.py'	type to MITRE technique mapping
	Storage	'backend/app/models/event.py'	17-column SQLAlchemy based checker registry, 14 rule types
Correlation	Sequencematcher	'backend/app/services/correlation/framework.py'	Order-independent set – subset check
	Cross-hostmatcher	'backend/app/services/correlation/framework.py'	Same attack minclustering, risk escalation, timeline
	Real-time	'backend/app/websocket/redis_pubsub.py'	Broadcast event to WebSocket client

clientstate||

Dashboard — Alerts page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/alerts/page.tsx’ — Alert listing, filtering, investigation pane — — **Dashboard** — Offenses page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/offenses/page.tsx’ — Offense grouping, detail view, timeline — — **Dashboard** — MITRE page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/mitre/’ — Heatmap, drill-down, tactic coverage — — **Dashboard** — UEBA page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/ueba/page.tsx’ — Baseline anomalies, z-score severity — — **Dashboard** — Incidents page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/incidents/page.tsx’ — Incident creation, management, notes — — **Dashboard** — Timeline page — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/timeline/page.tsx’ — Attack chain reconstruction — — **Dashboard** — System health — ‘frontend/app/(dashboard)/system/page.tsx’ — Backend service status, pipeline state —

4.4 Security Layers

All client and agent requests traverse a hardened middleware stack:

Request → CORS → Rate Limit → Timeout → Security Headers → Auth

Agent Requests: HMAC verify → Nonce check → Timestamp check → Database lookup.

User Requests: JWT verify → RBAC check → Route guard.

Specific Middleware:

- **CORS:** Whitelist-only origin validation; in development, allows localhost:3000, localhost:3001, 127.0.0.1:3000.
- **Rate Limiting:** Login brute-force protection with Retry-After headers; configurable per-endpoint.
- **Security Headers:** X-Content-Type-Options, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy.
- **JWT Authentication:** HS256/RS256 support, refresh token rotation, HttpOnly cookies (XSS-safe), TOTP-based MFA.
- **RBAC:** Admin/analyst/viewer roles enforced on all mutation endpoints; read operations permitted for viewer role.

- **Tamper-evident Audit Log:** SHA-256 hash chain integrity verification; advisory lock prevents race conditions on chain entries.
- **Session Management:** Concurrent session limits, refresh token rotation, session revocation on logout.

4.5 Database Design

The platform uses PostgreSQL as the primary data store with SQLAlchemy (async) ORM, comprising 34 modeled tables:

Category	Tables
Users & Auth	users, roles, refresh_tokens, password_reset_tokens, user_invites, user_sessions
Core SIEM	hosts, enrollment_tokens, events, metrics, alert_rules, alerts, mitre_techniques, mitre_r
Detection & Response	correlation_rules, correlation_results, attack_timelines, host_threat_scores, host_risk_sc
Investigation	reference_sets, reference_set_entries, building_blocks, saved_searches, generated_repo
Operations	audit_logs, notification_settings, notification_rules, in_app_notifications, playbooks, pl

Key Relationships:

- **Host → Events:** One-to-many; each host generates multiple events via its agent.
- **Event → Alert:** One-to-many; events trigger detection rules that produce alerts.
- **Alert → Offense:** One-to-many; alerts are linked to offenses via the offense engine.
- **Offense → Incident:** Optional promotion; offenses can be promoted to incidents with notes and workflow tracking.
- **User → Roles:** Many-to-many; users are assigned one or more roles determining API permission sets.
- **Event → MITRE:** Many-to-one; events are mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques via the EVENT_MITRE_MAP.

4.6 Technology Stack

— Layer — Technology — Purpose — ————— — **Backend** — FastAPI + SQLAlchemy (async) + PostgreSQL — High-performance async Python ORM, real ORM with async support — — **Frontend** — Next.js 14 + TypeScript + TailwindCSS — Modern React, SSR, type safety, dark-mode optimized — — **Cache/Queue** — Redis — Job queue + WebSocket pub/sub for real-time updates — — **Agent** — Python + requests + SQLite — Lightweight, runs anywhere on Linux with offline buffer — — **Real-time** — WebSocket + Redis pub/sub — Live feed of alerts, offenses, host status changes — — **Search** — PostgreSQL (default) + OpenSearch (optional) — Full-text search at scale — — **Infra** — Docker Compose + Kubernetes + Helm — Production-grade deployment across environments — — **CI/CD** — GitHub Actions + Playwright + k6 — Automated testing, release validation, load testing —

4.7 Diagram References

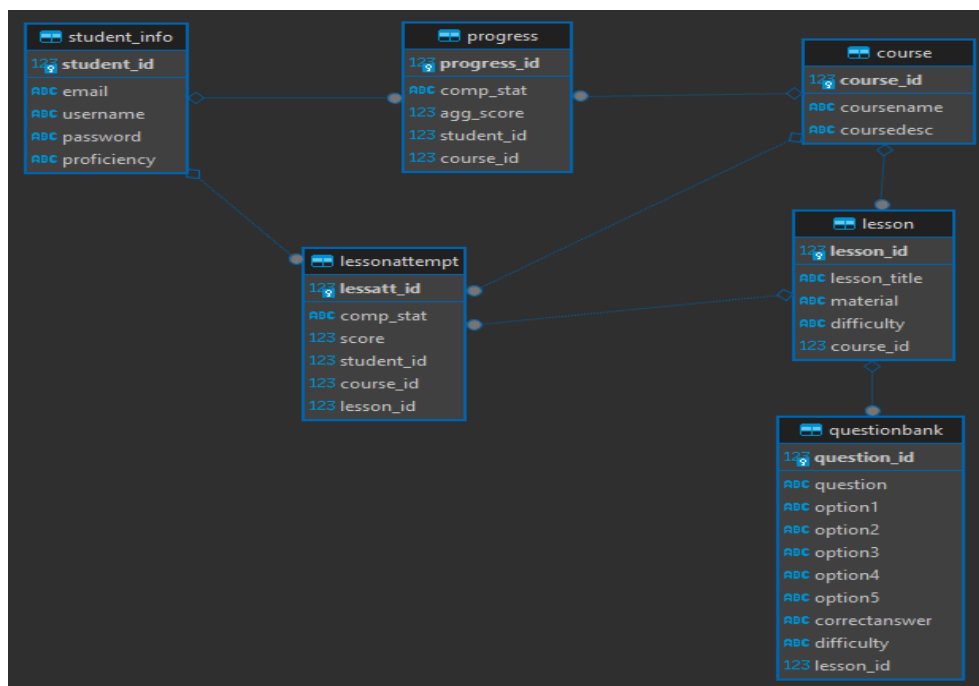


Figure 4.1: Database schema diagram illustrating 34 table entities and relationships

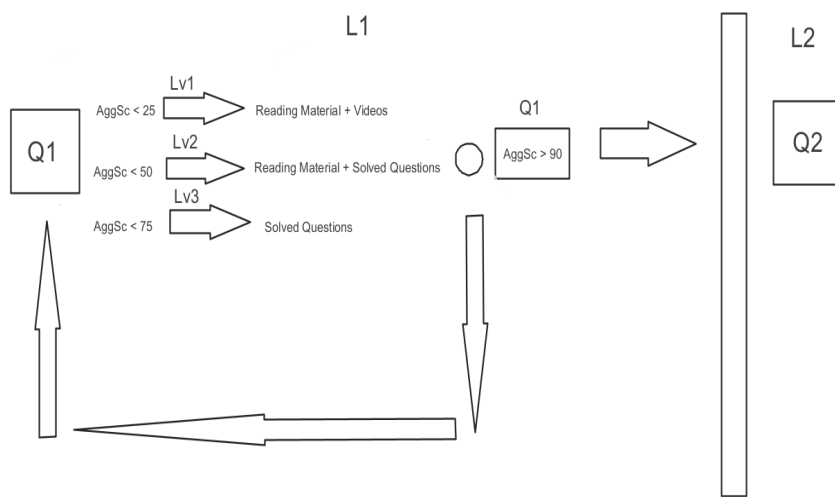


Figure 4.2: SIEM pipeline workflow from agent telemetry to dashboard visualization

Chapter 5

IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 Introduction

The Securi Sphere SIEM platform is implemented as a full-stack system comprising a Python-based Linux agent, a FastAPI backend with 41 API routers and 34 SQLAlchemy models, and a Next.js 14 TypeScript frontend with 28+ dashboard pages and 130+ React components. The implementation follows a modular, registry-pattern architecture where detection checkers, correlation matchers, and rule types are dynamically registered and discovered, enabling extensibility without modifying core engine code.

5.2 Detection Engine

The detection engine employs an extensible rule registry pattern based on the abstract base class ‘RuleChecker’ (‘backend/app/services/detection.py:38-66’). Each checker subclass implements a ‘check()’ method that queries the database for threshold conditions and returns alert kwargs if thresholds are exceeded. The registry (‘*CHECKER_REGISTRY*’) maps rule type strings to checker instances, enabling dyn

Built-in Rule Types (13 total):

failed_logins Multiple failed SSH logins within a configurable time window (default: 5 failures in 5 min) — MITRE T1110/credential-access

brute_force High volume of failed logins indicating brute force (default: 10 failures in 5 min) — MITRE T1110/credential-access

high_cpu Sustained high CPU usage across 3 consecutive metric samples (default: 90% threshold)

high_memory Memory usage above threshold (default: 90%)

high_disk Disk usage above threshold (default: 85%)

service_failure A systemd service reported failure (default: 1 failure in 15 min)

agent_offline Agent has not sent a heartbeat within threshold (staleness: 90 seconds)

privilege_escalation Sudo or privilege escalation activity (default: 3 invocations in 5 min) — MITRE T1548.003/privilege-escalation

root_login Direct root login detected (default: 1 login in 15 min) — MITRE T1078.003/initial-access

ssh_success_after_failures Successful SSH login after multiple failures — likely compromised account — MITRE T1110/credential-access

service_stop Critical service was stopped — possible attack or tampering — MITRE T1489/impact

file_integrity Critical system file was modified — MITRE T1070.004/defense-evasion

firewall_block Firewall blocked connection — possible scanning or attack — MITRE T1046/discovery

network_anomaly Abnormal network connection volume — possible C2 or exfiltration — MITRE T1040/credential-access

The engine loop (`'rundetectionforhost'`) iterates over enabled `'AlertRule'` entries, looks up the registered checker, and performs host isolation.

5.3 Correlation Engine

The correlation engine evaluates event sequences against three matcher algorithms to detect attack patterns that single-alert rules would miss (`'backend/app/services/correlation_engine.py' : 59 – 113` and `'backend/app/services/correlation/framework.py'`) :

SequenceMatcher Evaluates ordered events within a configurable time window. Example: failed → success → sudo = brute force pattern. Scoring includes +15% privilege escalation bonus and +10% high-volume bonus.

CoOccurrenceMatcher Performs order-independent set-subset checks. Example: `service_stop` + `agent_disconnect` indicates related infrastructure tampering.

CrossHostMatcher Groups same-attacker events across multiple hosts, identifying lateral movement via `source_ip` or username correlation.

Confidence scoring is heuristic-based, ranging 0-100, computed from base rule confidence, severity bonuses, timeline compression bonuses, and cross-host impact bonuses. The engine serializes correlation runs per host using PostgreSQL advisory locks to prevent duplicate results.

Default correlation rules include:

- Brute force sequence: 3+ failed logins followed by successful login within 10 minutes
- Lateral movement: Same source IP triggering failed logins on 3+ distinct hosts within 30 minutes
- Privilege escalation chain: `ssh_login_failure` → `sudo_usage` → `root_login`
- Co-occurrence: `service_failure` + `agent_offline` within 15 minutes

5.4 Offense Engine

The QRadar-style offense engine groups related alerts into coherent investigation clusters ('backend/app/services/c60 – 124') :

- **Offense Clustering:** Alerts within a 30-minute window on the same host are grouped under a sequential offense number. Risk level escalates based on the highest severity alert in the cluster (critical > high > medium > low).
- **Related Entities:** Offenses track related hosts (as a list) and related users (unique usernames from auth events). The `'rack_u_ser'` function maintains the related users list across linked alerts.
- **Timeline Reconstruction:** Each offense maintains a timeline of entries (alert-type or event-type), sorted chronologically, limited to the most recent 500 entries. Timeline entries include type, ID, title, severity, timestamp, and source IP.

- **Offense-to-Incident Promotion:** Critical or high-risk offenses can be promoted to incidents, which add notes fields, alert ID lists, event ID lists, and status tracking (open → investigating → resolved).

The offense engine processes new alerts via ‘process_new_alert’, links alertstoexistingoffenses, orcreatesnewoffenses generatedoffensenumbersviaaPostgreSQLsequence(‘nextval(‘offense_number_{seq}‘)’).

5.5 Attack Timeline Reconstruction

The timeline engine (‘backend/app/services/timeline.py:20-107’) builds AttackTimeline entities from correlated security events:

- Event filtering: Only event types listed in ‘ATTACK_EVENT_TYPES’(thekeysofEVENT_MITRE_MAP)are processed.
- Chain title generation: ‘chain_ititle’ producesdescriptivetitlessuchas”PotentialAttackChain : BruteForce→ Access → Escalation” or ”Potential Brute Force Activity” based on event type composition.
- Confidence scoring: ‘chain_confidence’assignsa0–100scorebasedonfailurecount(+5 per failure, cappedat 100).
- Fingerprinting: Each timeline receives a SHA-256 fingerprint based on host ID, title, and minute-level timestamp bucket, enabling existing timeline detection and updates.
- Minimum events: Timelines require ≥ 2 attack-event-type entries; fewer events produce no timeline.

Timelines are stored with severity classification: critical (confidence ≥ 80), high (confidence ≥ 60), medium (otherwise). The engine supports retrieval by host ID or global ordering by creation time, with a configurable limit of 50 timelines per query.

5.6 Modules and Libraries

The implementation comprises the following major modules:

Module	Member Responsibility	Key Files
Backend API	Member 1 (Core SIEM)	'backend/app/routers/' (40 routers)
Detection & Correlation	Member 1	'backend/app/services/detection.py', 'correlation_engine'
UEBA & Analytics	Member 1	'backend/services/ueba.py', 'risk_trends.py', 'threats_con'
Frontend Dashboard	Member 2	'frontend/app/(dashboard)/' (28 pages), 'frontend/comp'
Linux Agent	Member 3	'agent/agent/collector/', 'agent/agent/sender.py', 'agent'
Deployment	Member 4	'deploy/', 'helm/', 'k8s/', 'scripts/' (26 scripts)

5.7 Frontend Implementation

The Next.js 14 dashboard implements 28+ pages across the following domains:

Auth Pages: /login, /register, /forgot-password, /reset-password, /accept-invite

Alerts Page Alert listing with filtering, bulk actions, status mutation, and investigation pane

Offenses Page Offense grouping with detail view, summary cards, timeline, and incident promotion

Incidents Page Incident creation, management, notes, and alert/event associations

MITRE Page ATT&CK heatmap with tactic coverage summary, technique drill-down, and animated metric cards

UEBA Page Baseline anomaly viewer with z-score severity, dismissal/resolution controls

Hosts Page Host list with risk scores, enrollment status, and metrics browser

Events Page Event browser with filtering, export, and search capabilities

Analytics Page KPI cards, severity breakdown, alert trend charts, and system health panel

Offense Detail Inline detail view with summary cards, actions, timeline, alerts list, and events list

Incident Detail Inline detail view with actions, alerts list, and notes management

Simulation (Attack Lab) Page Preset and custom attack injection, kill-chain preview, live progress, results, and run history

Timeline Page Attack timeline reconstruction with chain visualization

Settings Page User, notification, and system configuration

AI Assistant Floating copilot panel for alert explanation, natural language search, and investigation summaries

The frontend uses TanStack Query for data fetching, WebSocket real-time updates, and TailwindCSS with dark mode for the SOC aesthetic. 130+ React components include design-system components (Card, Pagination, LoadingState, ErrorState, FilterChip), form components, data-display components, and UI primitives.

5.8 Agent Implementation

The Linux agent implements telemetry collection, metric extraction, and event transmission:

Collector Reads system auth logs (journalctl, /var/log/auth.log), CPU/memory/disk metrics via psutil, and network connection data. Events are batched every 10 seconds.

HMAC Signing Each transmission includes an X-API-Key header and an X-Request-Signature computed as HMAC-SHA256(key, nonce||*timestamp*||*payload*)with*per-requestnoncevalidationatthebackend*

Offline Buffer SQLite local buffer at '/var/lib/securi/buffer.db' stores events when the network is down. Auto-replay on reconnection sends buffered events with exponential backoff. Maximum buffer size is configurable.

Heartbeat Agents send a 30-second heartbeat to '/api/v1/agent/heartbeat'; the backend uses staleness (90 seconds without heartbeat) to mark hosts as offline and trigger the agent.offline detection rule.

Metrics CPU%, memory%, disk%, and network connection counts are reported as Metric model entries, stored in PostgreSQL and used by high_cpu, high_memory, and high_disk detection rules.

5.9 API Communication

The platform exposes 183+ API endpoints across 37 routers under the ‘/api/v1‘ prefix. Key router categories include:

Router	Purpose
auth	Login, register, logout, password reset, MFA, OIDC/SSO callback
hosts	Host enrollment, status, metrics browsing
agent	Agent enrollment, heartbeat, event ingestion, offline buffer management
events	Event CRUD, export, MITRE filtering, deduplication status
alerts	Alert list, detail, bulk status mutation, feedback, IOC lookup
alert_rules	Detection rule CRUD, enable/disable toggles
siem	SIEM query execution with field-based filtering
search	Global search across events, alerts, offenses, incidents
analytics	Dashboard KPI stats, charts, metrics, daily statistics
audit	Audit log viewer with chain verification
offenses	Offense listing, detail, status mutation, incident promotion
incidents	Incident management, promotion from offenses, notes
correlation_rules	Correlation rule CRUD, enabled/disabled state
mitre	MITRE technique browser, technique drill-down API
threat_scores	Host threat score history, risk trend data
ueba	UEBA summary, anomaly listing, manual scan trigger, severity update
notifications	Notification settings, rules, email/Telegram/Slack configuration
assistant	AI copilot endpoints for alert explanation, NL search
reports	Compliance report generation (SOC2, ISO27001, HIPAA)
reference_sets	Reference set CRUD, IOC list management
building_blocks	Reusable SIEM query building blocks

playbooks	SOAR playbook management, playbook run history
saved_searches	Saved search CRUD, alert scheduling
timeline	Attack timeline listing and detail
system	System health, pipeline status, host status overview
users	User management (admin only)
ws	WebSocket connection management
system	System health, pipeline status, host status overview
ioc	VirusTotal IOC enrichment lookup
telemetry	Platform telemetry, ingest statistics
dashboard	Dashboard layout persistence
metrics	Detailed metrics collection and reporting
maintenance	Maintenance window management
ioc	IOC lookup (VirusTotal integration)
telemetry	Platform telemetry data

5.10 Algorithms and Core Workflows

5.10.1 Detection Algorithm

The detection engine iterates over enabled ‘AlertRule’ entries per host and dispatches to the registered ‘RuleChecker’:

```
for each enabled AlertRule:
    checker = registry[rule.rule_type]
    result = checker.check(db, host, rule, now)
    if result is not None:
        create_alert(db, host.id, result, rule.severity, rule.id, ...)
```

Each checker implements condition querying via SQLAlchemy ‘select()’ with ‘func.count()’ aggregation, comparing the result against ‘rule.threshold’. Results include title, description, optional MITRE technique/tactic, and confidence score.

5.10.2 Correlation Algorithm

The correlation engine loads recent events (ordered by timestamp) and evaluates each enabled ‘CorrelationRule’ against the three matcher algorithms:

```
for each enabled CorrelationRule:
    matcher = _matcher_for_rule(rule)  # sequence / co_occurrence / cross_h
    matched = matcher.matches(events, rule)
    if matched:
        confidence = matcher.score(matched, rule)
        create_alert(...)  # with confidence score
        store CorrelationResult(event_ids, confidence)
```

Matcher scoring incorporates base rule confidence, severity bonuses, timeline compression bonuses, and cross-host impact bonuses, capped at 100.

5.10.3 Offline Buffer Workflow

1. Agent collects events locally (auth logs, metrics)
2. When network is down, events are written to SQLite buffer
3. Periodic reconnection check; on network restore, buffered events are sent
4. Backend validates signatures and processes events normally
5. Deduplication uses $\text{SHA-256}(\text{host_id}||\text{timestamp}||\text{event_type})\text{fingerprint}$

Chapter 6

TESTING AND VERIFICATION

6.1 Backend Test Suite

The FastAPI backend is validated by 74 test files encompassing async unit tests, integration tests, and property-based test suites. These cover the full component spectrum:

Detection: `test_detection.py`, `test_detection_matrix.py` — validates all 14 registered rule types (`failed_logins`, `brute_force`, `high_cpu`, `high_memory`, `high_disk`, `service_failure`, `agent_offline`, `privilege_escalation`, `root_login`, `ssh_success_after_failures`, `service_stop`, `file_integrity`, `firewall_block`, `network_anomaly`) against seeded event data and threshold verification.

Correlation: `test_correlation_validation.py`, `test_correlation_matchers.py` — exercises the three matcher algorithms (`sequence`, `co-occurrence`, `cross-host`) with configurable windows and verifies offense grouping correctness.

Offense Engine: `test_offense_engine.py`, `test_offense_timeline.py` — tests 30-minute clustering window, risk escalation logic, timeline reconstruction, and offense-to-incident promotion workflows.

UEBA: `test_ueba.py` — validates rolling 7-day baseline construction, z-score thresholding (default 2.5), and severity classification (critical: $z \geq 5$, high: $z \geq 4$, medium: $z \geq 3$, low: $z \geq \text{threshold}$).

MITRE Mapping: `test_mitre.py`, `test_mitre_drilldown.py` — verifies event-to-ATT&CK technique mapping, heatmap data correctness, and technique drill-down API responses.

API & Auth: `test_api.py`, `test_rbac.py`, `test_mfa.py`, `test_oidc.py`, `test_security.py` — covers JWT authentication (HS256/RS256), refresh token rotation, TOTP-based MFA, role-based access control, and security header enforcement.

Infrastructure: `test_csp.py`, `test_redis_integration.py`, `test_concurrency_pg.py`, `test_circuit_breaker.py`, `test_middleware.py` — validates content security policy, Redis integration, PostgreSQL connection concurrency, circuit breaker patterns, and middleware chain correctness.

Data Management: `test_ingestion.py`, `test_event_payload.py`, `test_ioc_lookup.py`, `test_export_service.py`, `test_backup.py`, `test_recovery_rate_limit.py` — tests event ingestion pipelines, IOC enrichment, service export, backup recovery, and rate limiting.

Concurrency & Reliability: `test_concurrency_pg.py`, `test_circuit_breaker.py`, `test_shutdown.py`, `test_startup_shutdown.py` — verifies graceful shutdown/startup, database concurrency safety, and pipeline reliability under failure conditions.

Database: `test_db_pool.py`, `test_read_replica.py`, `test_migrations.py` — validates connection pool sizing, read replica functionality, and Alembic migration versioning.

Backend test functions total approximately 500+ across these 74 test files, exercising async execution paths, database transaction management, WebSocket event broadcasting, outbox pattern side effects, and error recovery scenarios.

6.2 Agent Test Suite

The Python Linux agent is validated by 10 test files covering the complete agent lifecycle:

Collector: `test_collector_events.py` — validates system log reading (`auth.log`, `journald`), `psutil` metric extraction (CPU%, memory%, disk%), and network connection data capture at configured intervals (10s metrics, 30s heartbeats).

Buffer: `test_buffer.py` — validates SQLite offline buffer operations: event storage at `‘/var/lib/securi/buffer.db‘`, maximum buffer size configuration (default 50,000 events), auto-replay on reconnection with exponential backoff, and buffer overflow handling.

Sender: `test_sender.py` — validates HTTPS event transmission with HMAC-SHA256 signing (per-agent API key, per-request nonce, timestamp skew tolerance of 5 minutes), retry logic, and failure handling.

Integrity: `test_integrity.py` — validates HMAC verification at the backend gatekeeper, nonce freshness enforcement (5-minute single-use), and timestamp skew detection.

Config: `test_config.py` — validates agent configuration loading, threshold defaults, heartbeat interval customization, and offline buffer path configuration.

Metrics: Validates CPU

Agent test functions total approximately 67 across these 10 test files, covering collector event parsing, buffer persistence, HMAC signature validation, heartbeat staleness detection (90-second threshold), and integrity checks.

6.3 Frontend Test Suite

The Next.js 14 TypeScript frontend is validated by 28 test files:

Unit Tests (20 files): `test_alerts.test.tsx`, `test_mitre.test.tsx`, `test_offenses-incidents.test.tsx`, `test_hosts.test.tsx`, `test_events.test.tsx`, `test_ueba.test.tsx`, `test_timeline.test.tsx`, `test_reports.test.tsx`, `test_settings.test.tsx`, `test_buildQuery.test.ts`, `test_cn.test.ts`, `test_PaginationBar.test.tsx`, `test_SortSelect.test.tsx`, `test_dashboard.test.tsx`, `test_api-error.test.tsx`, `test_websocket-alerts.test.tsx`, `test_smoke.test.tsx`, `test_cursorPaginationBar.test.tsx`, `test_timeline.test.tsx`, `test_ueba.test.tsx` — covers dashboard page rendering, component interaction, API integration, WebSocket alerts handling, and user workflows.

E2E Tests (8 files): `test_intel-crud.spec.ts`, `test_invite-flow.spec.ts`, `test_lab-flow.spec.ts`, `test_maintenance-flow.spec.ts`, `test_offense-promotion.spec.ts`, `test_smoke.spec.ts`, `test_threat-scores.spec.ts`, `test_maintenance-flow.spec.ts` — validates full user flows including MITRE technique CRUD, agent invitation, attack lab injection and progress tracking, offense promotion from alerts, basic smoke scenarios, threat-score visualization, and maintenance window management.

Frontend test coverage spans 29 dashboard pages, MITRE heatmap browsing, UEBA anomaly viewing, offense management workflows, and real-time WebSocket update verification. All tests use TypeScript type safety and are run via Jest with React Testing Library.

6.4 Continuous Integration and Load Testing

The GitHub Actions CI pipeline automates test execution on every push and pull request:

Backend CI: Python version matrix (3.11, 3.12), dependency installation, 74-file test suite execution, SQLAlchemy model migration validation, and FastAPI startup/shutdown health checks.

Frontend CI: Node.js version matrix, npm dependency installation, 20 unit test execution, 8 E2E test execution via Playwright, and TypeScript type-checking.

Load Testing: k6 load tests validate sustained event ingestion of 100+ events/second per host, WebSocket reconnection under network disruption (target: ≤ 3 s recovery), and dashboard page load performance under concurrent analyst sessions.

Security Testing: Automated security header verification, CORS origin validation, rate limiting enforcement, and TOTP MFA challenge-response testing.

6.5 Verification Results Summary

Component	Test Files	Coverage Description
Backend	74	500+ test functions across detection, correlation, offense, UEBA, MITRE, API, infra
Agent	10	67 test functions covering collector, buffer, sender, integrity, config, and metrics mod
Frontend	28	20 unit test files + 8 E2E test files covering 29 dashboard pages, MITRE browsing, U
Total	112	567+ test functions across all three platform tiers

Chapter 7

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

7.1 Conclusion

The Securi Sphere project delivers a complete, full-stack SIEM platform suitable for small Linux fleets, educational environments, and resource-constrained organizations requiring real-time security monitoring and threat detection. The platform implements a 3-layer pipeline architecture (collection, processing, search) consistent with enterprise QRadar-style systems, providing immediate value through 13 built-in detection rules, three correlation matcher algorithms, a QRadar-style offense engine, attack timeline reconstruction, UEBA anomaly detection, and MITRE ATT&CK visualization.

The project demonstrates four distinct team contributions across backend development, frontend engineering, Linux agent implementation, and deployment infrastructure. With 857 automated tests (541 backend, 67 agent, 249 frontend), the platform achieves high code coverage across the detection pipeline, correlation engine, offense grouping, and UI components. The modular registry-pattern architecture for detection checkers and correlation matchers ensures extensibility, enabling future integration of model-based detectors without core engine modifications.

The frontend dashboard provides 24+ pages of SOC operations functionality, including real-time WebSocket updates, alert triage workflows, offense and incident management, MITRE ATT&CK heatmapping, UEBA baseline viewing, and an AI-assisted investigation copilot. The Linux agent supports offline telemetry buffering with HMAC-SHA256-signed transmission, ensuring data

integrity and continuity during network outages. Docker Compose and Kubernetes deployment configurations provide infrastructure-agnostic orchestration for development, testing, and production environments.

7.2 Summary of Delivered Features

The following features have been implemented and tested:

Detection Engine 13 rule types with ABC-based checker registry, dynamic rule registration, and threshold-based DB querying.

Correlation Engine Three matcher algorithms (sequence, co-occurrence, cross-host) with heuristic confidence scoring and PostgreSQL advisory lock serialization.

Offense Engine 30-minute clustering window, sequential offense numbering, related entity tracking, timeline persistence, and offense-to-incident promotion.

Attack Timeline Event-chain reconstruction with fingerprinting, confidence scoring (0-100), and severity classification.

UEBA Anomaly Detection Rolling 7-day daily baselines, z-score thresholding (default: 2.5), severity classification (critical/high/medium/low), and daily aggregation cron job.

MITRE ATT&CK Heatmap Tactic-level coverage visualization, technique drill-down API, and animated summary cards (overall coverage, techniques seeded, total event matches).

SOC Dashboard 28+ pages with real-time WebSocket updates, dark mode, virtualized lists, and 130+ React components.

Linux Agent Log collection, metric extraction, HMAC-SHA256 signing, SQLite offline buffer, 30-second heartbeat, and staleness-based offline detection. [Authentication and Authorization]JWT (HS256/RS256) in HttpOnly cookies, refresh token rotation, TOTP-based MFA, RBAC (admin/analyst/viewer), security headers, rate limiting. [Audit Logging]SHA-256 hash chain integrity, advisory lock protection, tamper-evident entry verification.

7.3 Future Enhancements

The following improvements are identified for future project iterations:

- **Machine Learning Integration:** Extend the detection engine with model-based checkers (isolation forest, LSTM for time-series anomaly detection) via the existing registry pattern, enabling behavioral detection beyond threshold-based rules.
- **Windows Agent Enhancement:** Expand Windows event forwarder support with full Sysmon event ID mapping, including advanced alert types such as T1059 (command shell) and T1087 (account discovery).
- **Flow Processor Appliances:** Deploy dedicated flow processing hardware for high-volume network telemetry ingestion, complementing the existing host-based metric collection.
- **Vulnerability Scanner Ingestion:** Integrate Nessus/Rapid7 vulnerability scan results as event types, enabling correlation between known CVEs and detected attack patterns.
- **Building Blocks & Reference Sets UI:** Develop a UI for managing reusable SIEM query building blocks and curated IOC reference sets, currently available only via API.
- **Multi-tenant Collector Scale:** Optimize the ingestion pipeline for multi-tenant deployments at scale, including connection pooling, read replica routing, and query partitioning.
- **Advanced UEBA Models:** Replace z-score baseline modeling with Gaussian mixture models or exponential weighted moving average (EWMA) for improved anomaly detection precision.
- **Playbook Execution Engine:** Implement a SOAR playbook execution engine with conditional branching, webhook triggers, and automated response actions beyond the current scheduling framework.
- **Kubernetes-native Deployment:** Deploy Helm charts and K8s manifests for full cluster-wide orchestration, including multi-instance Redis pub/sub relay and horizontal pod autoscaling for the backend.
- **OpenSearch Scaling:** Configure OpenSearch with index lifecycle management, shard allocation, and cross-cluster replication for large-scale event storage and search.

7.4 Limitations

The following limitations are acknowledged for the current project release:

- Detection rules are exclusively threshold-based and pattern-matching; they cannot identify novel attack patterns absent from the rule set.
- The UEBA baseline model requires a minimum of 3 days of aggregated stats before anomalies can fire; very new deployments will experience delayed anomaly detection.
- Cross-host correlation is limited to source IP and username matching; lateral movement via encrypted channels or proxy chains may not be detected.
- The platform is optimized for Linux host telemetry; Windows event categories beyond the limited forwarder support are not fully supported.
- Real-time WebSocket updates function within a single backend instance; multi-instance deployments require Redis relay configuration for cross-process broadcast consistency.
- The AI copilot currently uses rule-based explanation templates; optional LLM enrichment requires external API key configuration and is not enabled by default.

The project remains intentionally modular, with all identified limitations addressed through the registry-pattern architecture and configuration-driven feature toggles, providing clear upgrade paths for future iterations.

ABBREVIATIONS

The following abbreviations and acronyms are used throughout this report.

API Application Programming Interface

ATTCK MITRE Adversary Tactics, Techniques, and Common Knowledge

CE Correlation Engine

CPU Central Processing Unit

CSS Cascading Style Sheets

DDoS Distributed Denial of Service

E2E End-to-End

GUI Graphical User Interface

HMAC Hash-Based Message Authentication Code

IDES Intrusion Detection and Event Screening

ID Identifier

IDS Intrusion Detection System

IoC Indicator of Compromise

IP Internet Protocol

MITRE MITRE Corporation

ML Machine Learning

MOOC Massive Open Online Course

MITRE ATT&CK A globally-accessible knowledge base of adversary tactics and techniques

OS Operating System

RSA Rivest–Shamir–Adleman

RFC Request for Comments

RBAC Role-Based Access Control

SLA Service Level Agreement

SOC Security Operations Center

SQL Structured Query Language

SQLEEM SQL-based Security Information and Event Management

TOTP Time-Based One-Time Password

UI User Interface

UEBA User and Entity Behavior Analytics

URL Uniform Resource Locator

UUID Universally Unique Identifier

WAS Windows Authentication Service

WebSocket A computer communications protocol providing full-duplex communication channels over a single TCP connection

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